

C922

Emerging Trends and Challenges in 21st Century Nursing Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A university with a new health sciences building schedules nursing, pharmacy, and physical therapy students into the same lecture on diabetes, but students sit by program and never interact. The lecture hall seats 300. Does this meet the definition of interprofessional education?

- A. No; IPE requires students to learn about, from, and with each other, which needs interaction.
- B. Yes, because several professions attended.
- C. Yes, because the hall holds all three programs together.
- D. No, because IPE must always take place in clinical settings.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity best meets the definition of interprofessional education?

- A. Each program runs its own simulation of the same case.
- B. Nursing students watch a video about what pharmacists do.
- C. A nursing-only team-building day.
- D. Nursing and pharmacy students jointly plan medication teaching for a simulated patient, then debrief each other's roles.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A program in a state that recently raised nursing faculty salaries has too few clinical sites. Its board of nursing allows some simulation to replace clinical hours. The program owns five high-fidelity manikins. Based on the NCSBN national simulation study, what is a defensible plan?

- A. Do not count simulation toward clinical hours at all.
- B. Replace all clinical hours with simulation.
- C. Replace up to about half of clinical hours with high-quality simulation led by trained faculty with structured debriefing, within board rules.
- D. Replace any amount, as long as all five manikins are used.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A program plans to replace 50% of clinical hours with simulation but has no trained facilitators and no structured debriefing. What is the main problem?

- A.** No problem; 50% is allowed in every case.
- B.** Board of nursing rules do not apply to simulation.
- C.** 50% is too low; it should be 100%.
- D.** The study's results depended on trained faculty and structured debriefing, so outcomes may not match.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A nursing school that recently upgraded its campus Wi-Fi turns away qualified applicants each year for lack of faculty and clinical placements. A nearby health system, which has a new marketing director, employs experienced master's-prepared nurses and wants more new graduates. What strategy best addresses both problems?

- A.** An academic-practice partnership, such as health-system nurses serving as clinical faculty on dedicated education units.
- B.** Replace clinical faculty with online self-study over the new Wi-Fi.
- C.** Launch a campaign to attract more applicants.
- D.** Cut enrollment further.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A nurse educator at a school that recently moved to block scheduling is redesigning exams because the Next Generation NCLEX emphasizes clinical judgment. The program's pass rate last year was 91%. What change best aligns exams with the NGN?

- A.** Keep current exams, since a 91% pass rate shows no change is needed.
- B.** Add unfolding case studies that ask students to recognize and analyze cues, prioritize hypotheses, take action, and evaluate outcomes.
- C.** Test the nursing process as a memorized list of steps.
- D.** Add more recall items on lab values.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A nurse educator who also coaches a youth soccer team systematically studies whether her flipped-classroom redesign improved pharmacology exam scores and publishes the results. Her school holds an annual research day. Under Boyer's model, which type of scholarship is this?

- A. Not scholarship, because it concerns her own course.
- B. Scholarship of application.
- C. Scholarship of teaching.
- D. Scholarship of discovery.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A nurse educator writes a review that synthesizes findings from nursing, psychology, and education research into a new framework for clinical reasoning. Which Boyer type is this?

- A. Scholarship of teaching.
- B. Scholarship of discovery.
- C. Scholarship of application.
- D. Scholarship of integration.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A nurse educator at a college with a new nursing lab learns that a pending state bill would cut funding for nurse faculty loan forgiveness. She teaches a policy course with 45 students. What is the most effective first advocacy step?

- A. Stay out of it; educators should not engage in policy.
- B. Study the bill and gather evidence on the faculty shortage, then contact legislators directly or through a professional organization.
- C. Require her 45 students to email legislators her personal opinion for a grade.
- D. Wait until the bill passes, then object.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A dean at a school that recently won a sustainability award wants to buy virtual-reality headsets for every student after seeing them at a conference. The vendor offers a 20% discount this month. What should the nurse educator recommend first?

- A.** Buy now to get the discount.
- B.** Buy the headsets, then find uses for them.
- C.** Identify the learning outcomes VR would serve and the evidence for it, then pilot and evaluate, including cost and accessibility.
- D.** Never use VR, since technology harms learning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

At a nursing school with a new courtyard, a few faculty eagerly tried AI-assisted feedback tools in the first month. Now a respected group of faculty whom others look to for advice is starting to use them after seeing results. The school has 40 faculty. In Rogers's diffusion of innovation, which group are these respected faculty?

- A.** Laggards.
- B.** Early adopters.
- C.** Innovators.
- D.** Early majority.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In Rogers's model, which group is skeptical and adopts an innovation only after most others have, often from peer pressure or necessity?

- A.** Late majority.
- B.** Innovators.
- C.** Early majority.
- D.** Laggards.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A university ~~with a new health sciences building~~ schedules nursing, pharmacy, and physical therapy students into the same lecture on diabetes, but students sit by program and never interact. ~~The lecture hall seats 300.~~ Does this meet the definition of interprofessional education?

Target word: is it IPE **Decides:** No interaction between professions.

A	Correct	Shared attendance alone is not IPE.
B	Dropped element	Drops the interaction requirement.
C	Camouflage	Room size does not create interprofessional learning.
D	Absolute language	IPE can happen in classrooms and simulation.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

Which activity best meets the definition of interprofessional education?

Target word: identify IPE — reversed **Decides:** Two professions working and learning together.

A	Adjacent category	Parallel activities without interaction.
B	Dropped element	Learning about another profession, but not with it.
C	Confusion set	Teamwork within one profession is not interprofessional.
D	Correct	They learn about, from, and with each other.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A program ~~in a state that recently raised nursing faculty salaries~~ has too few clinical sites. Its board of nursing allows some simulation to replace clinical hours. ~~The program owns five high fidelity manikins.~~ Based on the NCSBN national simulation study, what is a defensible plan?

Target word: defensible substitution **Decides:** Study evidence supports up to 50% with high-quality simulation.

A	Inverted operation	The board allows it and evidence supports limited substitution.
B	Absolute language	The study did not test full replacement.
C	Correct	Matches the study's conditions and findings.
D	Camouflage	Equipment count does not set the evidence-based limit.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A program plans to replace 50% of clinical hours with simulation but has no trained facilitators and no structured debriefing. What is the main problem?

Target word: which condition is missing **Decides:** The study's results depended on simulation quality.

A	Dropped element	Drops the quality conditions.
B	Adjacent category	Boards regulate how simulation counts.
C	Inverted operation	Moves further from the evidence.
D	Correct	Quantity without quality does not reflect the evidence.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A nursing school ~~that recently upgraded its campus Wi-Fi~~ turns away qualified applicants each year for lack of faculty and clinical placements. A nearby health system, ~~which has a new marketing director,~~ employs experienced master's-prepared nurses and wants more new graduates. What strategy best addresses both problems?

Target word: strategy for shared problem **Decides:** Each partner has what the other lacks.

A	Correct	Shares experts and placements and grows the workforce pipeline.
B	Camouflage	Network upgrades do not replace clinical teaching.
C	Adjacent category	Applicants are not the shortage; capacity is.
D	Inverted operation	Worsens the workforce shortage.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A nurse educator at a school ~~that recently moved to block scheduling~~ is redesigning exams because the Next Generation NCLEX emphasizes clinical judgment. ~~The program's pass rate last year was 91%.~~ What change best aligns exams with the NGN?

Target word: NGN-aligned change **Decides:** NGN measures clinical judgment steps.

A	Camouflage	Past results under the old exam do not show NGN readiness.
B	Correct	Matches the clinical judgment measurement model.
C	Confusion set	Naming steps is not applying judgment to a case.
D	Adjacent category	Recall does not measure clinical judgment.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A nurse educator ~~who also coaches a youth soccer team~~ systematically studies whether her flipped-classroom redesign improved pharmacology exam scores and publishes the results. ~~Her school holds an annual research day.~~ Under Boyer's model, which type of scholarship is this?

Target word: Boyer type **Decides:** Systematic study of teaching, made public.

A	Absolute language	Boyer counts systematic, public study of teaching.
B	Adjacent category	Application uses expertise to solve practice or community problems.
C	Correct	Studying and sharing results about teaching and learning.
D	Confusion set	Discovery is original research to create new disciplinary knowledge.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A nurse educator writes a review that synthesizes findings from nursing, psychology, and education research into a new framework for clinical reasoning. Which Boyer type is this?

Target word: Boyer type — reversed **Decides:** Synthesis across fields.

A	Confusion set	It does not study her teaching.
B	Confusion set	No new primary research is done.
C	Inverted operation	Application takes knowledge into practice; this pulls knowledge together.
D	Correct	Integration connects knowledge across disciplines.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A nurse educator at a college ~~with a new nursing lab~~ learns that a pending state bill would cut funding for nurse faculty loan forgiveness. ~~She teaches a policy course with 45 students.~~ What is the most effective first advocacy step?

Target word: first advocacy step **Decides:** The bill is still pending.

A	Absolute language	Policy advocacy is part of the educator role.
B	Correct	Informed, evidence-based engagement before the vote is effective advocacy.
C	Camouflage	Uses the class-size detail and pressures students; it is not sound advocacy.
D	Inverted operation	Acting after the decision reverses the order.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A dean at a school ~~that recently won a sustainability award~~ wants to buy virtual-reality headsets for every student after seeing them at a conference. ~~The vendor offers a 20% discount this month.~~ What should the nurse educator recommend first?

Target word: adoption process **Decides:** No outcome or evidence has been defined.

A	Camouflage	Price timing does not show learning value.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the outcome-first order.
C	Correct	Pedagogy comes before technology.
D	Absolute language	Technology can help when matched to outcomes.

11. Answer B Concept 8

At a nursing school ~~with a new courtyard~~, a few faculty eagerly tried AI-assisted feedback tools in the first month. Now a respected group of faculty whom others look to for advice is starting to use them after seeing results. ~~The school has 40 faculty.~~ In Rogers's diffusion of innovation, which group are these respected faculty?

Target word: adopter category **Decides:** Respected opinion leaders who follow the first venturers.

A	Inverted operation	Laggards adopt last, if at all.
B	Correct	Early adopters are opinion leaders whom others look to.
C	Confusion set	Innovators were the few who tried it first.
D	Confusion set	The early majority is deliberate but not usually the opinion leaders.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

In Rogers's model, which group is skeptical and adopts an innovation only after most others have, often from peer pressure or necessity?

Target word: adopter category — reversed **Decides:** Skeptical, after the majority.

A	Correct	The late majority adopts after most others, out of necessity or pressure.
B	Inverted operation	Innovators adopt first and eagerly.
C	Confusion set	The early majority adopts before the average member.
D	Confusion set	Laggards are last and tied to tradition.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Interprofessional education	IPE occurs when students of two or more professions learn about, from, and with each other; interaction is required.	Counting shared attendance as IPE.	Several professions in the same room — do they interact?
2	Simulation in place of clinical hours	The NCSBN national study found comparable outcomes when up to half of clinical hours were replaced with high-quality simulation, with trained faculty and structured debriefing, within board of nursing rules.	Assuming any amount or any quality of simulation substitutes.	A clinical-site shortage and a simulation substitution plan.
3	Academic-practice partnerships	Partnerships share clinical experts, faculty roles, and placements to address both faculty shortages and workforce needs.	Cutting enrollment or solving only one side of the problem.	A school short on faculty and a health system short on graduates.
4	Next Generation NCLEX and clinical judgment	NGN measures clinical judgment (recognize cues, analyze cues, prioritize hypotheses, generate solutions, take action, evaluate outcomes), best prepared for with unfolding cases.	Adding more recall items or relying on past pass rates.	Exam redesign for NGN.
5	Boyer's model of scholarship	Discovery = original research; integration = synthesis across fields; application = using knowledge to solve real problems; teaching = systematic study of teaching and learning.	Calling a study of one's own teaching "discovery" or not scholarship at all.	What the scholarly work does: new knowledge, synthesis, use, or teaching inquiry.
6	Policy advocacy	Effective advocacy starts by understanding the issue and gathering evidence, then engaging lawmakers directly or through professional organizations, before decisions are final.	Staying out of policy, or acting only after a bill passes.	A pending bill that affects nursing education.
7	Adopting educational technology	Start from learning outcomes and evidence, then pilot and evaluate, including cost and accessibility.	Buying technology because it is new or discounted.	A leader excited by a conference demo or vendor offer.
8	Rogers's diffusion of innovation	Innovators → early adopters (respected opinion leaders) → early majority → late majority (skeptical, adopt after most others) → laggards (tied to tradition).	Confusing early adopters with innovators or the early majority.	How and why a group adopts, and whether others look to them.

Course scope (public description): Emerging Trends and Challenges in 21st Century Nursing Education analyzes the emerging trends, technologies, and challenges that academic nurse educators encounter when facilitating learning in diverse healthcare settings. Students will focus on the necessity of interprofessional collaboration and the barriers and facilitators to overcoming the challenges associated with teaching and learning in nursing. Topics include the impact of emerging technology, challenges in nursing practice, and the role of the academic nurse educator as a scholar and a nursing education policy advocate. This course has no prerequisites.